counterintelligence had been informed about the presence of some foreign operatives and he feared the queries were about the band of three.

It was later learnt that Filipe had spoken to his young European mistress about his plan to settle in Australia. The unidentified young woman knew how to listen. And when Filipe disclosed the fact that he was being helped by the Indians, she made her move. Filipe had been picked up by Rabuka's soldiers the very next evening and he readily agreed to betray the Indian spies. This treachery bought him clemency.

The next few days for the three spies were full of sound and fury, said Shekhawat. 'Three officers from Rabuka's military landed in Sydney sometime in the second week of August,' he said. 'They had contacted Australian immigration to help them identify an Indian, Kailash Singh. Since Kailash was operating undercover, the Australians had no information about him. They placed a watcher at the Adelaide cafe where Kailash had recruited Filipe, but he never arrived. They sent an emissary to the Indian embassy in Australia, looking for Kailash, and were categorically told that the embassy was not aware of any such Indian in Australia. The band had shifted base to a safe house in Melbourne arranged by Taylor. But because of Filipe's betrayal, the operation lost a few precious weeks.'

The crisis, however, was not over. The three Fijian officers returned to Suva in late August to update the dictator about the blank they had drawn and to extract more information from Filipe, if he had held back any. They returned to Sydney around the second week of September 1989. By this time, the Indians were back in the game. They used Taylor and his network to inform the Australian authorities that Fijian soldiers were